EDWINNOVA 2026

Application Proposal Guidelines

How to Submit a Winning Application

Introduction

Thank you for your interest in EDWINNOVA 2026! This document will guide you through creating a strong application proposal that showcases your startup idea and team capabilities.

We are selecting teams based on idea quality, technical capability, and team strength. Your proposal is your first pitch - make it compelling!

What We're Looking For

✓ **A Real Problem:** Solve an actual problem, not just "cool tech"

✓ **Market Potential:** Show there's a real market for your solution

✓ **Technical Feasibility:** Can you build a working prototype in 48 hours?

✓ **Strong Team:** Right mix of skills to execute

✓ **Business Thinking:** Thought beyond just the product

Application Components

Your application must include:

1. Team Information

- Team Name
- Product Manager (PM) Name and Contact (Email + Phone)
- All 5 Team Members with roles:
- - 1 Product Manager (PM) - Mandatory
- - 4 Developers/Designers (specify exact roles: Frontend, Backend, Designer, etc.)

Important:

Tell us who does what. Clear role distribution shows you're organized.

2. Innovation Domain Selection

Select ONE domain for your startup:

- □ ROOTCODE
- □ TIDEHACK
- □ WILDCARD

Note:

Your idea must clearly fit your chosen domain.

3. Your Startup Idea (300-400 words)

What to Include:

- Problem Statement: What problem are you solving? Be specific.
- Who faces this problem? (Target users)
- Current solutions and why they fail
- Your proposed solution in 2-3 sentences
- Why your solution is better/different

Good Example:

"Coastal Karnataka farmers struggle to get fair prices because they have no visibility into real-time mandi rates. Our SMS-based system sends daily prices in Kannada to any mobile phone, helping 50,000+ farmers."

Bad Example:

"We will use AI to solve all farming problems."

4. Target Market (200-250 words)

- Who are your users? (Be specific)
- How many potential users? (Market size)
- Will they pay? How much?
- Who are your competitors?
- Your advantage over competitors

5. Business Model (200-250 words)

- How will you make money?
- Who pays?
- Pricing (Be specific - ₹X per month/transaction)
- Main costs

- How do you scale?

What NOT to say:

"We will figure out revenue later" or "Our product is free"

6. Technical Plan (200-250 words)

- Technology stack (Languages, frameworks)
- Key features you WILL build in 48 hours
- APIs or services you will use
- Why your team can execute this

Be realistic:

Focus on what's achievable in 48 hours, not everything you dream of building.

7. Team Proof of Work

Required:

- GitHub profiles for all developers
- Portfolio links for designers (Behance, Dribbble, Figma)
- Resumes for all 5 team members (PDF format)
- Brief description of each member's relevant experience (2-3 lines per person)

Note:

We want to see active GitHub profiles and real design work, not empty repos or generic portfolios.

How Applications Are Evaluated

Criteria	Weight
Problem & Solution Quality	30%
Market Understanding	20%
Technical Feasibility	20%
Business Model	15%
Team Capability	15%

Common Mistakes to Avoid

✕Being vague ("We will solve agriculture problems")

✗Buzzwords without substance ("AI-blockchain solution")

✗Unrealistic scope ("Build the next Google in 48 hours")

✗No clear users ("Everyone will use this")

✗Ignoring competition ("No one else does this")

✗Weak team (all developers, no PM)

✗Poor writing (spelling errors, unclear)

✗No business model ("Will figure out revenue later")

Tips for Success

✓ Start with a real problem you or someone you know faces

✓ Be specific - numbers, names, locations

✓ Show, don't tell (GitHub activity > claiming expertise)

✓ Proofread everything

✓ Be realistic about 48-hour scope

✓ Focus on ONE problem, solve it well

✓ Submit early

Submission Guidelines

Format:

- Single PDF document
- File name: TeamName_Domain_EDWINNOVA2026.pdf
- Maximum 5 pages (excluding resumes)
- Font: Arial or Times New Roman, 11pt minimum

Attachments:

- Main proposal PDF (max 5 pages)
- Team resumes - all 5 members (combined or individual PDFs)
- GitHub links (include in proposal)
- Designer portfolios (include links in proposal)

Proposal Structure (5 Pages Max)

Page 1: Cover + Team Info + Domain Selection

Page 2: Problem & Solution

Page 3: Market Analysis & Business Model

Page 4: Technical Plan & Team Capability

Page 5: Conclusion

Keep it concise!

Quality over quantity. Judges value clear, focused proposals over lengthy ones.

Questions?

 edwins@aiet.org.in
 +91 8951169155
 www.edwinslab.com

Good luck! We look forward to your innovative ideas.

- Team EDWINNOVA